Vocabulary

a) Idioms

We have already learnt that idiom is an expression in English, with a special meaning of its own.

i) Given below are some idiomatic expressions with their meanings. Understand the meaning.

a) wait for the dust to settle	-	to wait for a situation to become clear or certain
b) get/have all your ducks in a row	-	to have made all the preparations needed to do something / to be well organized
c) fetch and carry (for somebody)	-	to do a lot of little jobs for somebody as if you were their servant
d) do the math	-	to think carefully about something before doing it, so that you know all the relevant facts or figures
e) round the corner	-	very near

ii) Fill in the blanks with the right idioms. Choose from the above given idioms.

a) The Sherpas are cheerful, gallant men, who_____ tents, oxygen, food etc., for climbers during their ascent of the summit.

b) The team _____ carefully so as to reach the summit successfully.

c) When they had to climb through deep new snow the party sometimes had to _____.

d) Each member of the team had all their _____.

e) We could not believe that with a few more whacks of the ice axe in the firm snow we were _____ to the top.

iii) Understand the meaning of the given idiomatic expression and choose the right one to complete the sentence.

the icing on the cake – something extra and not essential, but is added to make it even better

break the ice – to make people more relaxed, especially at the beginning of the meeting

a) The conference room was silent though packed. The chairman introduced an interactive session to _____.

b) Our headmistress not only promised us to take us for an excursion, but also announced that on return we would get a holiday. It was like_____.

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